

The Study of the End Times (19)

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Last week we went over who The Woman is in Revelation 12

Revelation 12:1–2 KJV 1900

¹ And there appeared a great wonder in heaven; a woman clothed with the sun, and the moon under her feet, and upon her head a crown of twelve stars:

² And she being with child cried, travailing in birth, and pained to be delivered.

This Woman symbolizes Israel.

We then looked at the Red Dragon

Revelation 12:3–4 KJV 1900

³ And there appeared another wonder in heaven; and behold a great red dragon, having seven heads and ten horns, and seven crowns upon his heads.

⁴ And his tail drew the third part of the stars of heaven, and did cast them to the earth: and the dragon stood before the woman which was ready to be delivered, for to devour her child as soon as it was born.

This is Satan, the devil. The one who has been trying to stop God's plan of redemption from the beginning. Also the one who will never and can never win.

we move right along to getting more details about this child that is born of the Woman.

Revelation 12:5–6 KJV 1900

⁵ And she brought forth a man child, who was to rule all nations with a rod of iron: and her child was caught up unto God, and to his throne.

⁶ And the woman fled into the wilderness, where she hath a place prepared of God, that they should feed her there a thousand two hundred *and* threescore days.

Pray.

These details and description make it crystal clear that this Child is speaking of Jesus Christ.

Psalms 2 is written by King David and is about the Reign of the LORD and His anointed.

When speaking about the people devising plans and the kings of the earth attempting to take power he writes...

Psalm 2:9 KJV 1900

⁹ Thou shalt break them with a rod of iron; Thou shalt dash them in pieces like a potter's vessel.

Later in Revelation we learn more of Jesus' victories...

Revelation 19:15 KJV 1900

¹⁵ And out of his mouth goeth a sharp sword, that with it he should smite the nations: and he shall rule them with a rod of iron: and he treadeth the winepress of the fierceness and wrath of Almighty God.

I want to make something clear tonight. Some people have a hard time connecting in their mind the LORD of Hosts from the OT and the reigning and conquering King of kings in Revelation to the meek and mild Jesus of the Gospels.

Because God is love. Because He is the Prince of Peace. Because He is the Almighty. Because He is holy and righteous and perfect in character and nature...

He MUST be wrathful and terror inflicting on the sins of the world. It is the only way He can be perfect in all of His ways.

Jesus is going to reign and He will destroy anyone who does not submit to His will.

The sad part about that is that His will is for our good and His glory!

We then get to the next detail in Revelation 12:5

Revelation 12:5 KJV 1900

⁵ And she brought forth a man child, who was to rule all nations with a rod of iron: **and**

her child was caught up unto God, and to his throne.

This Child being “caught up unto God, and to His throne” is speaking of the ascension of Christ.

This is not speaking here of the rapture of the church, though the same word is used for “caught up”

We know Jesus lived, died and rose again...but there’s even more to the Gospel.

He also ascended and will return. That is the whole Gospel.

Acts 1:8–12 KJV 1900

⁸ But ye shall receive power, after that the Holy Ghost is come upon you: and ye shall be witnesses unto me both in Jerusalem, and in all Judaea, and in Samaria, and unto the uttermost part of the earth.

⁹ And when he had spoken these things, while they beheld, he was taken up; and a cloud received him out of their sight.

¹⁰ And while they looked stedfastly toward heaven as he went up, behold, two men stood by them in white apparel;

¹¹ Which also said, Ye men of Galilee, why stand ye gazing up into heaven? this same Jesus, which is taken up from you into heaven, shall so come in like manner as ye have seen him go into heaven.

¹² Then returned they unto Jerusalem from the mount called Olivet, which is from Jerusalem a sabbath day’s journey.

This is where Master’s Voice got there song “This Same Jesus”

This same Jesus, the One who opened blinded eyes
This same Jesus, the One the soldier pierced His side
This same Jesus, the One who died for my sin
This same Jesus, is gonna come back again!

If that don’t fire you up, your wood is wet.

Jesus is at His throne now, awaiting the time to gather His Bride the Church.

But then we get some more details here in Revelation 12:6

Revelation 12:6 KJV 1900

⁶ And the woman fled into the wilderness, where she hath a place prepared of God, that they should feed her there a thousand two hundred *and* threescore days

This time frame equals to three and a half years or 42 months of 30 days each.

Matthew referred to this time in Matthew 24:16

Matthew 24:16 KJV 1900

¹⁶ Then let them which be in Judaea flee into the mountains:

This is at the beginning of the Great Tribulation.

The Antichrist breaks his covenant of peace with Israel and things take a serious uptick in persecution.

God has always protected His people, and will not stop now or in the end.

Remember this is all symbolic rather than literal here in these descriptions. This detail symbolizes the protection God will give.

So, Jesus is at His throne. God's people are being protected. Next we see a war break out in heaven.

Revelation 12:7-12 KJV 1900

⁷ And there was war in heaven: Michael and his angels fought against the dragon; and the dragon fought and his angels,

⁸ And prevailed not; neither was their place found any more in heaven.

⁹ And the great dragon was cast out, that old serpent, called the Devil, and Satan, which deceiveth the whole world: he was cast out into the earth, and his angels were cast out with him.

¹⁰ And I heard a loud voice saying in heaven, Now is come salvation, and strength, and the kingdom of our God, and the power of his Christ: for the accuser of our brethren is cast down, which accused them before our God day and night.

¹¹ And they overcame him by the blood of the Lamb, and by the word of their testimony; and they loved not their lives unto the death.

¹² Therefore rejoice, ye heavens, and ye that dwell in them. Woe to the inhabitants of the earth and of the sea! for the devil is come down unto you, having great wrath, because he knoweth that he hath but a short time.

Micheal and his angelic army fight Satan and his demonic army.

The timing of this particular battle is somewhat up for debate. Some want to put it with the first coming of Christ.

They would refer to when Jesus spoke to the disciples in Luke 10:17-20

Luke 10:17–20 KJV 1900

¹⁷ And the seventy returned again with joy, saying, Lord, even the devils are subject unto us through thy name.

¹⁸ And he said unto them, I beheld Satan as lightning fall from heaven.

¹⁹ Behold, I give unto you power to tread on serpents and scorpions, and over all the power of the enemy: and nothing shall by any means hurt you.

²⁰ Notwithstanding in this rejoice not, that the spirits are subject unto you; but rather rejoice, because your names are written in heaven.

Now, we do not have time to go through what exactly Jesus is saying here and the timing of this, although we do know that Jesus has always been because Jesus is God...

BUT, when compared to the details in Revelation 12 there really is not enough correlation.

This in addition to the fact that we know the Devil has been active throughout the church age. We see this all throughout scripture.

For example...1 Peter 5:8

1 Peter 5:8 KJV 1900

⁸ Be sober, be vigilant; because your adversary the devil, as a roaring lion, walketh about, seeking whom he may devour:...

So, when we look at the text here we can make an educated assumption that this war happens in the end times.

So, is Satan really in heaven right now?

Revelation 12:10 KJV 1900

¹⁰ And I heard a loud voice saying in heaven, Now is come salvation, and strength, and the kingdom of our God, and the power of his Christ: for the accuser of our brethren is cast down, which accused them before our God day and night.

We see all the way back in Job's day that Satan went to and from the heavenly realm...

Job 1:6 KJV 1900

⁶ Now there was a day when the sons of God came to present themselves before the LORD, and Satan came also among them.

So it should come as no surprise that this war takes place in heaven.

The devil and his demons were not strong enough, and Micheal and the angels kicked satan out of heaven.

We then get a song of praise!

Revelation 12:10–11 KJV 1900

¹⁰ And I heard a loud voice saying in heaven, Now is come salvation, and strength, and the kingdom of our God, and the power of his Christ: for the accuser of our brethren is cast down, which accused them before our God day and night.

¹¹ And they overcame him by the blood of the Lamb, and by the word of their testimony; and they loved not their lives unto the death.

This is the martyrs singing of victory through Jesus!

In these verses we see both a praise but also a warning.

Revelation 12:12 KJV 1900

¹² Therefore rejoice, ye heavens, and ye that dwell in them. Woe to the inhabitants of the earth and of the sea! for the devil is come down unto you, having great wrath, because he knoweth that he hath but a short time.

I like how the Bible Knowledge Commentary explains this...

The Bible Knowledge Commentary 12:10–12

The devil knew that his time was limited to 1,260 days, the period of the Great Tribulation. By no stretch of the imagination can these prophecies be spread to cover the whole Interadvent Age as some attempt to do.

What does Satan do during this time?

Revelation 12:13–14 KJV 1900

¹³ And when the dragon saw that he was cast unto the earth, he persecuted the woman which brought forth the man *child*.

¹⁴ And to the woman were given two wings of a great eagle, that she might fly into the wilderness, into her place, where she is nourished for a time, and times, and half a time, from the face of the serpent.

Satan focuses his fury on Israel. God protects them by bringing them to a place of security.

The eagles wings represent a swift and powerful protection from God. We see this same illustrative language used in Exodus 19:4

Exodus 19:4 KJV 1900

⁴ Ye have seen what I did unto the Egyptians, and *how* I bare you on eagles' wings, and brought you unto myself.

How protected is the Woman?

Revelation 12:15–16 KJV 1900

¹⁵ And the serpent cast out of his mouth water as a flood after the woman, that he might cause her to be carried away of the flood.

¹⁶ And the earth helped the woman, and the earth opened her mouth, and swallowed up the flood which the dragon cast out of his mouth.

This is obviously all theatrical literature here to describe what is happening. All we can know for sure is that the devil turns his focus from a heavenly war to an earthly war, but God protects those Satan is trying to attack.

Satan now focuses even more on who he persecutes...

Revelation 12:17

Revelation 12:17 KJV 1900

¹⁷ And the dragon was wroth with the woman, and went to make war with the remnant of her seed, which keep the commandments of God, and have the testimony of Jesus Christ.

Now, some think that this verse proves that the Woman is not Israel but rather all of the believers. Therefore, the remnant are those who are upon the earth at the time of the Great Tribulation.

I understand this thought process, however, Gentiles did not birth Christ. Israel did. The line of David, specifically the tribe of Judah.

This remnant can still be the believers who are on the earth during this time both Jew and Gentile alike...why and how?

Romans 1:16 KJV 1900

¹⁶ For I am not ashamed of the gospel of Christ: for it is the power of God unto salvation to every one that believeth; to the Jew first, and also to the Greek

Either way, Satan is backed in a corner knowing he is defeated. He can try, but he will not succeed in getting one soul that God holds in His hands.

What a beautiful truth that is not just for the end times tribulation, but for today as well.